

# Claude Code Cheatsheet

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Daily essentials for maximum productivity

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# 1 How to Install

```
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code # Verify installation which claude && claude --version
```

**Health Check:** `claude doctor && claude mcp list`



## 2 Essential Commands

| Command                            | Action                                                     |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>/help</code>                 | Contextual help                                            |
| <code>/powerup</code>              | Interactive animated lessons teaching Claude Code features |
| <code>/clear</code>                | Reset conversation                                         |
| <code>/compact</code>              | Free up context                                            |
| <code>/status</code>               | Session state + context usage                              |
| <code>/context</code>              | Detailed token breakdown                                   |
| <code>/plan</code>                 | Enter Plan Mode (no changes)                               |
| <code>/ultraplan</code>            | Cloud Plan Mode: draft in cloud, review in browser         |
| <code>/execute</code>              | Exit Plan Mode (apply changes)                             |
| <code>/model</code>                | Switch model (sonnet/opus/opusplan)                        |
| <code>/insights</code>             | Usage analytics + optimization report                      |
| <code>/simplify</code>             | Detect over-engineering in changed code + auto-fix         |
| <code>/batch</code>                | Large-scale refactors via 5-30 parallel worktree agents    |
| <code>/teleport</code>             | Teleport session from web                                  |
| <code>/tasks</code>                | Monitor background tasks                                   |
| <code>/remote-env</code>           | Configure cloud environment                                |
| <code>/rc</code>                   | Start remote control session (Research Preview, Pro/Max)   |
| <code>/mobile</code>               | Get Claude mobile app download links                       |
| <code>/fast</code>                 | Toggle fast mode (2.5x speed, 6x cost)                     |
| <code>/voice</code>                | Toggle voice input (hold Space to speak)                   |
| <code>/recap</code>                | Session context summary on return to                       |
| <code>/exit g [name] rompt]</code> | Ending Claude Code session (logs in 10 min)                |

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## 3 Keyboard Shortcuts

| Shortcut                  | Action                                      |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <code>Shift+Tab</code>    | Cycle permission modes                      |
| <code>Esc × 2</code>      | Rewind (undo)                               |
| <code>Ctrl+C</code>       | Interrupt                                   |
| <code>Ctrl+R</code>       | Search command history                      |
| <code>Ctrl+L</code>       | Clear screen (keeps context)                |
| <code>Ctrl+B</code>       | Background tasks                            |
| <code>Ctrl+F</code>       | Kill all background agents (double press)   |
| <code>Alt+T</code>        | Toggle thinking on/off                      |
| <code>Space</code> (hold) | Voice input (requires <code>/voice</code> ) |
| <code>Tab</code>          | Autocomplete                                |
| <code>Shift+Enter</code>  | New line                                    |
| <code>Ctrl+D</code>       | Exit                                        |

**IDE Shortcuts:** VS Code `Alt+K` | JetBrains `Cmd+Option+K`

## 4 File References

@path/to/file.ts → Reference a file    @agent-name → Call an agent    !shell-command → Run shell command



## 5 Lesser-Known Features (But Official!)

| Feature             |           | What It Does                                                                |
|---------------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tasks API           |           | Persistent task lists with dependencies                                     |
| Background Agents   |           | Sub-agents work while you code                                              |
| Agent Teams         |           | Multi-agent coordination (TeamCreate/SendMessage)                           |
| Auto-Memories       |           | Automatic cross-session context capture                                     |
| Session Forking     |           | Rewind + create parallel timeline                                           |
| LSP Tool            |           | Code intelligence (go-to-def, refs), ~50ms vs 45s with grep                 |
| Voice Mode          |           | Native voice input, free transcription                                      |
| Remote Control      |           | Control local session from phone/browser (Research Preview, Pro/Max)        |
| Cloud/Desktop Tasks | Scheduled | Machine-off scheduling via <code>/schedule</code> or Desktop app            |
| Skill Evals         |           | A/B testing and trigger tuning for custom skills                            |
| Output Styles       |           | <code>/config</code> → Default, Explanatory, Learning modes                 |
| Rules Templates     |           | Ready-to-use <code>.claude/rules/</code> templates (arch/quality/test/perf) |

**Pro tip:** These aren't "secrets", they're in the [CHANGELOG](#). Read it!

## 6 Permission Modes

| Mode              | Editing                | Execution              |
|-------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| Default           | Asks                   | Asks                   |
| acceptEdits       | Auto                   | Asks                   |
| Plan Mode         | None                   | None                   |
| auto              | Classifier decides     | Classifier decides     |
| dontAsk           | Only if in allow rules | Only if in allow rules |
| bypassPermissions | Auto                   | Auto (CI/CD only)      |

**Shift+Tab** to switch modes

## 7 Memory & Settings (2 levels)

| Level    | Path                    | Scope              | Git |
|----------|-------------------------|--------------------|-----|
| Project  | <code>.claude/</code>   | Team               | Yes |
| Personal | <code>~/.claude/</code> | You (all projects) | No  |

**Priority:** Project overrides Personal

### 7.1 .claude/ Folder Structure

```
.claude/ |— CLAUDE.md      # Local memory (gitignored) |— settings.json  # Hooks (committed)
|— settings.local.json # Permissions (not committed)
|— agents/         # Custom agents |— hooks/         # Event scripts |— rules/         # Auto-loaded rules
| |— architecture-review.md | |— code-quality-review.md | |— test-review.md
| |— performance-review.md | |— skills/         # Slash commands + knowledge modules (unified)
```

## 8 Context Management (CRITICAL)

**Statusline:** Model: Sonnet | Ctx: 89.5k | Ctx(u): 56.0%

| ✔ 0-50% | ⚠ 50-70% | 💎 70-90% | 🏆 90%+ |
|---------|----------|----------|--------|
|         |          |          |        |

**Watch** `Ctx(u):` → >70% = `/compact` , >85% = `/clear`

| Sign                | Action                |
|---------------------|-----------------------|
| Short responses     | <code>/compact</code> |
| Frequent forgetting | <code>/clear</code>   |
| >70% context        | <code>/compact</code> |
| Task complete       | <code>/clear</code>   |

## 8.1 Context Recovery Commands

| Command                           | Usage                      |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <code>/compact</code>             | Summarize and free context |
| <code>/clear</code>               | Fresh start                |
| <code>/rewind</code>              | Undo recent changes        |
| <code>claude -c</code>            | Resume last session        |
| <code>claude -r &lt;id&gt;</code> | Resume specific session    |

## 9 Plan Mode & Thinking

| Feature   | Activation                                       | Usage                                               |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Plan Mode | <code>Shift+Tab × 2</code> or <code>/plan</code> | Explore without modifying                           |
| OpusPlan  | <code>/model opusplan</code>                     | Opus for planning, Sonnet for execution             |
| Ultraplan | <code>/ultraplan &lt;prompt&gt;</code>           | Cloud planning, browser review, terminal stays free |

**Opus 4.8:** Default effort is **xhigh**. Use `ultrathink` to force max effort for the next turn.

| Control                            | Action                    | Persistence |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Alt+T</b>                       | Toggle thinking on/off    | Session     |
| <b>/config</b>                     | Enable/disable globally   | Permanent   |
| <code>/effort</code> <b>slider</b> | low/medium/high/xhigh/max | Session     |
| <code>effort</code> <b>param</b>   | API only, per-request     | Per-request |

**Cost tip:** For simple tasks, Alt+T to disable thinking → faster & cheaper.

## 10 Typical Workflow

- |                  |                          |                   |                         |                  |                                     |
|------------------|--------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. Start session | → claude                 | 2. Check context  | → /status               | 3. Plan Mode     | → Shift+Tab × 2 (for complex tasks) |
| 4. Describe task | → Clear, specific prompt | 5. Review changes | → Always read the diff! | 6. Accept/Reject | → y/n                               |
| 7. Verify        | → Run tests              | 8. Commit         | → When task complete    | 9. /compact      | → When context >70%                 |



# 11 Quick Prompting Formula

WHAT: [Concrete deliverable]    WHERE: [File paths]    HOW: [Constraints, approach]    VERIFY: [Success criteria]

## Example:

Add input validation to the login form.    WHERE: src/components/LoginForm.tsx  
HOW: Use Zod schema, show inline errors    VERIFY: Empty email shows error, invalid format shows error

## 12 MCP Servers

| Server            | Purpose                                   |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Serena</b>     | Indexing + session memory + symbol search |
| <b>grepai</b>     | Semantic search + call graph analysis     |
| <b>Context7</b>   | Library documentation                     |
| <b>Sequential</b> | Structured reasoning                      |
| <b>Playwright</b> | Browser automation                        |
| <b>Postgres</b>   | Database queries                          |
| <b>doobidoo</b>   | Semantic memory + Knowledge Graph         |

**Serena memory:** `write_memory()` / `read_memory()` / `list_memories()`

Check status: `/mcp`

## 13 Search Tools Quick Reference

Quick decision: exact text → `rg` | exact name → `rg` /Serena | concept → `grepai` | structure → `ast-grep`

| Task                   | Tool                                        |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Find exact text        | <code>rg "TODO"</code>                      |
| Find auth-related code | <code>grepai search "authentication"</code> |
| Who calls a function   | <code>grepai trace callers "login"</code>   |
| Get file structure     | <code>serena get_symbols_overview</code>    |

## 14 CLI Flags Quick Reference

| Flag                                               | Usage                            |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <code>-p "query"</code>                            | Non-interactive mode (CI/CD)     |
| <code>-c</code> / <code>--continue</code>          | Continue last session            |
| <code>-r</code> / <code>--resume &lt;id&gt;</code> | Resume specific session          |
| <code>--teleport</code>                            | Teleport session from web        |
| <code>--model sonnet</code>                        | Change model                     |
| <code>--add-dir ../lib</code>                      | Allow access outside CWD         |
| <code>--permission-mode plan</code>                | Plan mode                        |
| <code>--worktree</code> / <code>-w</code>          | Run in isolated git worktree     |
| <code>--max-budget-usd 5.00</code>                 | Max API spend limit (print mode) |
| <code>--dangerously-skip-permissions</code>        | Auto-accept (use carefully)      |
| <code>--mcp-debug</code>                           | Debug MCP servers                |
| <code>--allowedTools "Edit,Read"</code>            | Whitelist tools                  |
| <code>--debug</code>                               | Debug output                     |

# 15 Anti-patterns

## ❌ Don't

- Vague prompts
- Accept without reading
- Ignore warnings
- Skip permissions
- Negative constraints only

## ✅ Do

- Specify file + line with @references
- Read every diff
- Use /compact at 70%
- Never in production
- Provide alternatives

## 16 Cost Optimization

| Model    | Use For                        | Cost   |
|----------|--------------------------------|--------|
| Haiku    | Simple fixes, reviews          | \$     |
| Sonnet   | Most development               | \$\$   |
| Opus     | Architecture, complex bugs     | \$\$\$ |
| OpusPlan | Plan (Opus) + Execute (Sonnet) | \$\$   |

# 17 Quick Decision Tree

Simple task → Just ask Claude    Complex task → Tasks API to plan first  
Risky change → Plan Mode first    Repeating task → Create agent or command    Context full → /compact or /clear  
Need docs → Use Context7 MCP    Deep analysis → Use Opus (thinking on by default)

## The Golden Rules

- 1 Always review diffs before accepting
- 2 Use /compact before context gets critical (>70%)
- 3 Be specific in requests (WHAT, WHERE, HOW, VERIFY)
- 4 Plan Mode first for complex/risky tasks
- 5 Create CLAUDE.md for every project
- 6 Commit frequently after each completed task
- 7 Know what's sent: prompts, files, MCP results → Anthropic

# 18 Common Issues Quick Fix

| Problem                 | Solution                                     |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| “Command not found”     | Check PATH, reinstall npm global             |
| Context too high (>70%) | <code>/compact</code> immediately            |
| Slow responses          | <code>/compact</code> or <code>/clear</code> |
| MCP not working         | <code>claude mcp list</code> , check config  |
| Permission denied       | Check <code>settings.local.json</code>       |
| Hook blocking           | Check hook exit code, review logic           |

**Health Check:** `which claude && claude doctor && claude mcp list`

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